

Industry News

Tablets to become a \$35-billion market by 2012

Tablets would grow into an enormous \$35-billion market by 2012, according to financial firm JP Morgan. However, this growth would come at the expense of other computing products such as laptops and notebooks.

JP Morgan estimates tablets to clock revenues of about \$26 billion in 2011 and \$35 billion in 2012. Unit shipments are expected to be 47.9 million in 2011 and 79.6 million in 2012.

"We expect tablets to have an increasingly negative impact on PC shipments. More than 35 per cent of tablets sold in 2012 will be cannibalistic, particularly in relation to notebooks and notebooks," said analyst Mark Moskowitz.

Tablet market growth will be spurred by improved operating system platforms and penetration of enterprise and education customer verticals.

By 2015, 70 per cent mobile phones to cost under \$100

The global average selling price for approximately 70 per cent (4.8 billion) of active mobile phones will fall under \$100 by 2015, according to a report by market research firm Evalueserve. This can be attributed to the increased competition among manufacturers and focus of manufacturers on lower-middle-income countries such as China and India that are cost-sensitive but volume-heavy.

Evalueserve estimates that the global handset demand will rise to approximately 2.58 billion in 2015, with the replacement market accounting for approximately 94 per cent of the gross demand.

"This change in buying behaviour will be driven by two factors: Rapid commoditisation of the mobile handset with progressively reducing price

HP's IPG business gets new head

Hewlett Packard (HP) India has appointed Neeraj Sharma as the vice-president of its Imaging and Printing Group (IPG) in India. Sharma will report to John Solomon, senior vice president, HP, Imaging and Printing Group (IPG), Asia-Pacific and Japan.

Ezekiel appointed as Samsung CMO

Samsung India has appointed Elkana Ezekiel as chief marketing officer. In this role, Elkana will head the corporate marketing function for Samsung India as well as develop and execute corporate marketing strategies in order to help the company achieve its targeted sales.

"My mandate will be to take the Samsung brand to the next level in terms of consumer connect by fully leveraging the Samsung brand and product strengths across the different business verticals of the company," said Ezekiel.

Lenovo gets new marketing head

Lenovo has appointed Shailendra Katyal as the marketing head for its India operations. Based out of the company's Bengaluru head office, Katyal will handle the company's master brand and lead marketing for the three business segments it operates in—consumer,

relational and SMB.

"We want to continue the momentum on our double-digit market share. Shailendra will aggressively chart out clear-cut marketing strategies to help us enhance our brand preference and consumer connect in India," said Amar Babu, managing director, Lenovo India.

Canon appoints new director

Canon India has appointed K. Bhashkar as the director of its Office Imaging Solution Division. Bhashkar has over 15 years of experience in enterprise domain of business solutions. His experience will be leveraged to bring more synergy and build this division to focus on medium and small enterprises.

STMicro appoints senior executives

STMicroelectronics has announced new appointments to its executive management team. Fabio Gualandris has rejoined the company as corporate vice president and director of product quality excellence, replacing Georges Auguste. He will report directly to Carlo Bozotti, president and CEO of ST.

Auguste has been appointed as the executive vice president, packaging and test manufacturing, reporting to chief operating officer Didier Lamouche.

points, and higher tendency to switch handsets, particularly in the mass-market segment due to the low switching cost," said Nitin Navish Gupta, assistant vice president, ICT practice, Evalueserve.

3G connections in India to grow three-fold in four years

The numbers of 3G subscriber connections in India will touch 400 million within four years, representing almost 30 per cent of the country's total subscribers—according to a Wireless Intelligence study.

Indian operators spent a combined

\$15 billion in acquiring WCDMA 3G spectrum at an auction last year and are forecast to jointly invest a further \$2.5 billion in building new networks and rolling out 3G services in 2011.

"Competition in the Indian 3G space is likely to be intense as most operators have set ambitious targets. Market share growth clearly depends on how fast operators can deploy 3G networks in their respective licenced areas, and how rapidly they can address demand in rural areas," said Joss Gillet, senior analyst at Wireless Intelligence.

The study notes that India's Circle A and Circle B service areas will ac-

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